

The Picture

A **wealthy** but **miserly** old man once **commissioned** a famous artist to paint a picture for him. He wanted the scene of Hanuman the monkey-god flying over the ocean, with the city of Lanka in flames in the background.

"The charge will be 10,000 rupees," said the artist.

The old man **rolled his eyes** in horror.

"Ten thousand!" he **exclaimed**. "That is too much for such a simple painting!"

"Well, I can't charge less than 8000 rupees then," replied the painter, a **trifle irritated**.

"No," **insisted** the old man. "Even that is way above the market rate."

"My last price is Rs. 7000, and not a paisa less," said the artist **curtly**, a look of **disgust** in his eyes.

"I will not pay you more than Rs. 5000," said the **miser** in an **obstinate** tone.

Finally the painter agreed, **sickened** by the **haggling**.

The **codger** made his **way out** of the studio, still **grumbling** about the large sum of money he had to **part** with.

Two days later, the old man was **taken aback** to be told that the painting was ready. When he **shuffled** into the studio, the artist removed the cloth covering the canvas with a **flourish**.

"**Behold!**" he cried. But **strain** as he might, the miser could see **nought** but a canvas painted bright blue all over.

"What is this?" he exclaimed. "I ordered a painting of Hanuman **leaping** over the ocean!"

"You are at this very moment looking at the ocean," replied the artist.

"But where is Hanuman?" **enquired** the old man.

"He has already leapt over the ocean to the other side," came the answer.

"And Lanka? I can't see any city in flames," the miser complained **petulantly**.

"Well," the artist continued. "It has **burned down** completely!"



Vocabulary

1. **Wealthy** (adjective) – rich, affluent, well-off, prosperous, moneyed समृद्ध
2. **Miserly** (adverb) – stingily, parsimoniously, penuriously, niggardly, tightfistedly कंजूसी से
3. **Commission** (verb) – hire, engage, order, contract, authorize काम सौंपना
4. **Roll one's eyes** (phrase) – give an eye-roll, look heavenward, show exasperation, scoff, glare upward आँखें घुमाना
5. **Exclaim** (verb) – cry out, exclaim aloud, shout, blurt, ejaculate (arch.) उत्स्फूर्त कहना
6. **Trifle** (noun) – a bit, a touch, a tad, a shade, a smidgen अल्प मात्रा
7. **Irritated** (adjective) – annoyed, vexed, peeved, nettled, irked खीझा हुआ
8. **Insist** (verb) – demand, persist, press, assert, stand firm अड़ जाना
9. **Curtly** (adverb) – brusquely, tersely, shortly, snappishly, abruptly रुखेपन से
10. **Disgust** (noun) – revulsion, loathing, distaste, abhorrence, nausea घृणा
11. **Miser** (noun) – skinflint, penny-pincher, tightwad, cheapskate, niggard कंजूस
12. **Obstinate** (adjective) – stubborn, adamant, intransigent, pigheaded, mulish हठी
13. **Sicken** (verb) – disgust, nauseate, repel, revolt, appall घिन दिलाना
14. **Haggling** (noun) – bargaining, wrangling, dickering, price-negotiation, huckstering मोलभाव
15. **Codger** (noun) – old man, geezer, fogey, curmudgeon, old-timer बूढ़ा
16. **Way out** (phrasal verb) – leave, step out, head out, make an exit, walk out बाहर निकलना
17. **Grumbling** (noun) – complaining, grouching, whining, muttering, bellyaching बड़बड़ाहट
18. **Part** (verb) – relinquish, give up, surrender, forgo, hand over छोड़ना
19. **Take aback** (phrasal verb) – startle, surprise, stun, shock, throw off चौंका देना
20. **Shuffle** (verb) – shamble, scuff along, trudge, plod, scuffle घिसटते हुए चलना
21. **Flourish** (noun) – grand gesture, fanfare, showy gesture, flamboyant sweep, dramatic flourish धूमधाम भरा इशारा
22. **Behold** (verb) – see, look at, gaze upon, observe, witness देखना
23. **Strain** (noun) – effort, exertion, stress, tension, struggle प्रयास

24. **Nought** (noun) – zero, nil, nothing, naught,
zilch शून्य

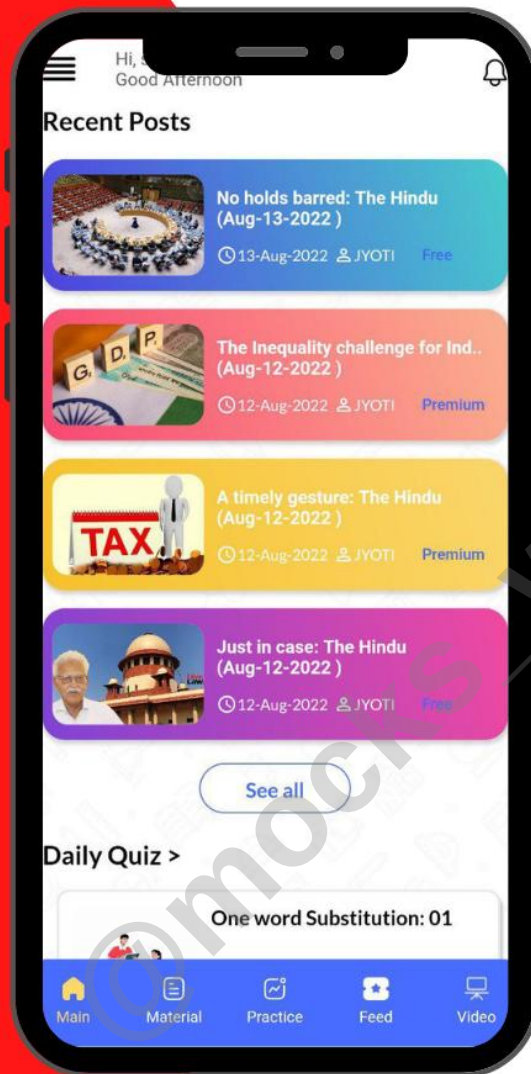
25. **Leap** (verb) – jump, spring, bound, vault,
hop छलांग लगाना

26. **Enquire** (verb) – ask, inquire, question,
query, seek information पूछना

27. **Petulantly** (adverb) – peevishly, irritably,
testily, querulously, sullenly झुझलाकर

28. **Burn down** (phrasal verb) – burn to the
ground, be razed, go up in flames, be
incinerated, reduce to ashes जलकर خاک
होना

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